KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 4: SHAPES AND SPACE · WEEK 19 · READING

Softer Than the Wind — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students tell a topic from a theme, find the theme shared by texts in different genres (a fable, a realistic story and a poem), support the theme with quoted evidence, and write an objective summary in their own words that keeps the most important events in order and leaves out opinions and small details.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: three texts share one theme: Aesop's fable "The Wind and the Sun," the realistic story "Juniper in the Tall Grass" about Tessa and a gray filly on a horse farm near Ocala, Florida, and the poem "What the River Knows." The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Week 18 Review (8 pts, 4 each): claim, evidence and counterclaim.
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W19.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: Topic or Theme? A topic is a word or two; a theme is a full-sentence message about life.
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 6 flip cards (theme, genre, moral, summary, determined, tremendous).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Text A: The Realistic Story (5 pts). Watch what Tessa tries first, what changes, and what she learns.
8. Slide 7 — Text B: The Poem (5 pts). Read the last stanza slowly; ask which two ways of changing stone the poet compares.
9. Slide 8 — One Theme, Different Genres (10 pts, 5 each): force fails, patience succeeds, in all three texts.
10. Slide 9 — Teach: Summarize Like a Pro. Four steps: who or what, problem or big idea, important events in order, ending. No opinions.
11. Slide 10 — Summary Detective (12 pts, 6 each): pick the strongest summary, spot what does not belong, catch the mistakes.
12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules. Titles of poems and stories go in quotation marks, with commas and periods inside.
14. Slide 13 — Back It Up With Evidence (4 pts): quote the sentence that supports the theme, starting with the tag shown. Checked exactly.

15. Slide 14 — Writer's Turn: Write a Summary (6 pts): one typed answer auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (allowed names count as one word); and the key events included. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): theme, genre and story words matched to meanings, 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick questions against the student's own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items across all three texts (find the theme, then check the evidence or the summary).
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W19.pdf), including the writing item and the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Theme Found!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Theme Tracker!" with the congratulations message "Theme tracker! You found one big idea hiding in a fable, a story, and a poem!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Keep Going!" with encouragement ("You're getting closer, and every try makes you stronger."), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: WEEK 18 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
`rv1_s0`	Set 1: "Our town should build a skate park. Last year, 300 people signed a petition asking for one." Which part is the EVIDENCE? [Last year, 300 people signed a petition asking for one. / Our town should build a skate park. / Skate parks are the best parks. / Some people think skate parks are noisy.]	**Last year, 300 people signed a petition asking for one.**	The petition with 300 signatures is a number that proves the reason, so it is evidence. The first sentence is the claim, "Skate parks are the best parks" is an unsupported opinion, and "Some people think skate parks are noisy" is a counterclaim (Week 18).
`rv2_s0`	Set 1: Type your answer: in an argument, the opinion of the OTHER side, which a strong writer answers, is called the ___.	**counterclaim** (also accepted: counterclaims, counter claim, counter-claim, counterargument, counter-argument, counter argument, opposing claim)	The other side's view, which a strong writer answers, is the counterclaim (Week 18).
`rv1_s1`	Set 2: Which sentence is a CLAIM? [Every town library should stay open on Saturdays. / The library opens at 9:00 in the morning. / In a survey, 40 families said they visit on weekends. / However, some people say Saturday hours cost too much.]	**Every town library should stay open on Saturdays.**	A claim is an opinion someone could argue about. The opening time is a fact, the survey is evidence, and the sentence starting with "However" is a counterclaim (Week 18).
`rv2_s1`	Set 2: Comma rule: retype the sentence with the missing comma. However the vote was very close.	**However, the vote was very close.**	An introductory word like "However" is followed by a comma (Week 18).

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv1_s2	Set 3: Find the correct one! Which sentence uses commas in a series correctly? [We packed water, sunscreen, and a map. / We packed water sunscreen, and a map. / We packed, water, sunscreen and, a map. / We packed water, sunscreen and, a map.]	**We packed water, sunscreen, and a map.**	Commas go between the items in a series: water, sunscreen, and a map. The other sentences leave a comma out or put commas where no list item ends (Week 18).
rv2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a reason tells WHY the writer believes the claim. The facts, numbers, and examples that PROVE the reason are called ___.	**evidence**	Facts, numbers, examples, and quotes that prove a reason are evidence (Week 18).

YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s0	Set 1: From the poem: "It leaves a jagged, broken shard." A hammer has just cracked the stone. Using the context, what does jagged most likely mean? [Having sharp, uneven edges / Smooth and perfectly round / Wet and slippery / Soft enough to bend]	**Having sharp, uneven edges**	A hammer blow breaks off a "broken shard," a piece of stone with rough, sharp, uneven edges. That is what jagged means.
v2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: the lesson stated in the last line of a fable, like "Kindness gets more done than force," is called the ___.	**moral** (also accepted: morals)	A lesson stated directly at the end of a fable is the moral.
v1_s1	Set 2: Which one is a THEME, not a topic? [Patience can accomplish more than force. / Horses / A river in Florida / The wind and the sun]	**Patience can accomplish more than force.**	A theme is a full-sentence message about life. "Horses," "A river in Florida," and "The wind and the sun" only name what a text is about, so they are topics.
v2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: a fable, a myth, a poem, and a realistic story are each a different ___.	**genre** (also accepted: genres)	A kind of writing, like a fable, a myth, a poem, or a realistic story, is a genre.
v1_s2	Set 3: From the story: "Ten minutes passed. Twenty. Her legs began to tingle." Using the context, what does tingle most likely mean? [Feel prickly, like pins and needles / Grow stronger and faster / Turn bright red from the sun / Kick out suddenly]	**Feel prickly, like pins and needles**	Tessa had been sitting still in the grass for twenty minutes. When you sit still that long, your legs feel prickly, like pins and needles. That feeling is a tingle.
v2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a short retelling of only the most important ideas, in order and in your own words, is a ___.	**summary** (also accepted: summaries)	A short retelling of only the most important ideas, in your own words, is a summary.

TEXT A: THE REALISTIC STORY (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: in paragraph 4, Uncle Femi says that to a horse, a loud girl running with a rope looks like a ___.	**mountain lion** (also accepted: lion, cougar, panther, puma)	In paragraph 4, Uncle Femi says, "To a horse, that looks like a mountain lion." A girl running at the filly looks like a predator.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s1	Set 2: Paragraph 2 ends: “The faster Tessa chased, the farther Juniper ran.” Which explanation of why the author includes this sentence is correct? [It shows that forcing the filly only made the problem worse. / It shows that Juniper is the fastest horse in Florida. / It shows that Tessa is a stronger runner than her uncle. / It shows that the pasture fence is broken.]	**It shows that forcing the filly only made the problem worse.**	The sentence shows that the harder Tessa pushed, the worse things got. Forcing the filly made the problem bigger, which sets up the change in paragraph 5.
sa_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: according to paragraph 6, about how long did Tessa sit in the grass before Juniper came to her?	**hour** (also accepted: hours, 60 minutes, sixty minutes)	Paragraph 6 begins, “After almost an hour, Tessa felt warm breath on her neck.”

TEXT B: THE POEM (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sb_s0	Set 1: Stanzas 1 and 2 contrast two ways of changing stone. Which pair does the poet compare? [A hammer that strikes hard and a river that smooths slowly / A turtle that rests and a lily that grows / The wind that blows and the sun that shines / A heart that moves and a mind that changes]	**A hammer that strikes hard and a river that smooths slowly**	Stanza 1 shows a hammer that “strikes the limestone hard,” and stanza 2 shows a river that “never strikes at all” but smooths the stone slowly. The poem contrasts force with patience.
sb_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: in which stanza does the speaker state the lesson directly to the reader? Type the stanza number.	**4** (also accepted: four, fourth, last, final)	Stanza 4 begins “So when you want to move a heart…” and tells the reader the lesson directly: be “patient, slow, and kind.”
sb_s2	Set 3: Careful! What is the TOPIC of the poem (not its theme)? [A river slowly shaping limestone / Patience and kindness can change what force cannot. / A hammer breaking a turtle’s shell / Lilies growing in a garden]	**A river slowly shaping limestone**	The topic is what the poem is about: a river slowly shaping limestone. “Patience and kindness can change what force cannot” is the THEME, a message about life, so it is the trap answer here.

ONE THEME, DIFFERENT GENRES (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp1_s0	Set 1: Which sentence states a theme that fits BOTH the story and the poem? [Patience and gentleness can accomplish what force cannot. / Horses are hard to catch. / Rivers carve stone over time. / Always obey your uncle.]	**Patience and gentleness can accomplish what force cannot.**	Only “Patience and gentleness can accomplish what force cannot” fits both texts and is a full-sentence message about life. “Horses are hard to catch” fits only the story, “Rivers carve stone over time” is a fact from the poem, and “Always obey your uncle” is a command that fits neither.
qp2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: two steps. In the story, Tessa chasing Juniper with a rope is the forceful way. Which object in the POEM plays that same role?	**hammer** (also accepted: hammers)	Tessa’s chasing is the forceful way that fails, just like the hammer that strikes hard in stanza 1.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp1_s1	Set 2: How do the story and the poem show the theme DIFFERENTLY? Which explanation is correct? [The story shows it through what Tessa does and learns; the poem shows it through images, then states it in the last stanza. / Both texts state the theme in their very first sentence. / The story states the theme in a moral at the end; the poem never hints at it. / The poem has characters who talk; the story is written in stanzas.]	**The story shows it through what Tessa does and learns; the poem shows it through images, then states it in the last stanza.**	The story never states the lesson; we see it through what Tessa does and learns. The poem builds the idea with the hammer and river images, then states it in stanza 4. Neither text states it in the first sentence, the story has no moral line, and the poem has no talking characters.
qp2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: in the fable, the Wind never changes its ways. In the story, Tessa does change. Which character gives the advice that leads to her change?	**femi** (also accepted: uncle femi, her uncle, uncle)	In paragraph 4, Uncle Femi tells Tessa, "Try being something else." His advice leads to her change.
qp1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Tobias wrote: "The theme of both texts is patience." What is wrong with his answer? ["Patience" is only a topic word. A theme must be a full sentence that says something about patience. / Patience does not appear in either text. / The theme should be about horses, because the story is first. / Nothing is wrong. One word is always a complete theme.]	**"Patience" is only a topic word. A theme must be a full sentence that says something about patience.**	"Patience" names a topic. A theme is a full sentence that says what the texts teach ABOUT patience, such as "Patience can accomplish more than force."
qp2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: two steps. Think back to the fable on the Picture It slide. Which character in the fable acts like Tessa with her rope and like the hammer in the poem?	**wind** (also accepted: the wind, north wind)	The Wind blows as hard as it can and fails, just like Tessa chasing with the rope and the hammer striking the stone.

SUMMARY DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s0	Set 1: Which is the BEST summary of "Juniper in the Tall Grass"? [Tessa tries to catch a young horse by chasing her, but the filly keeps running away. After her uncle's advice, Tessa sits quietly in the grass, and the filly finally comes to her and accepts the halter. / Tessa lives on a horse farm outside Ocala, Florida. She picks clover, and her uncle drinks coffee by the gate. / I think Tessa was silly to chase the horse, and this was the best story I have ever read. / Juniper goes to the barn for her checkup, and the doctor says she is healthy.]	**Tessa tries to catch a young horse by chasing her, but the filly keeps running away. After her uncle's advice, Tessa sits quietly in the grass, and the filly finally comes to her and accepts the halter.**	The best summary names Tessa and Juniper, gives the problem (the filly runs away), the turning point (her uncle's advice and sitting quietly), and the ending. The others list small details, give an opinion, or tell an event that never happens.
d2_s0	Set 1: Find the mistake! Corinne summarized the poem: "A hammer cracks limestone. Then the speaker gets angry and throws the hammer into the river. Turtles and lilies live there." What is the BIGGEST problem? [She added an event that is not in the poem: no one throws a hammer. / She used her own words instead of copying. / A summary of a poem should copy every stanza. / Summaries are never allowed to mention a hammer.]	**She added an event that is not in the poem: no one throws a hammer.**	A summary must stay true to the text. The speaker never throws a hammer into the river, so Corinne added an event that is not in the poem.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s1	Set 2: Which detail is too small to belong in a summary of the story? [Uncle Femi was holding a mug of coffee. / Tessa chased Juniper, and Juniper ran away. / Tessa sat quietly in the tall grass. / Juniper let Tessa slip the halter over her ears.]	**Uncle Femi was holding a mug of coffee.**	The coffee mug does not change what happens, so it is too small for a summary. The other three are key events: the chase, the turning point, and the ending.
d2_s1	Set 2: Dante says, "A summary and a theme are the same thing." Which explanation is correct? [No. A summary tells the most important events; a theme tells the message about life those events show. / Yes. Both retell everything that happens, in order. / No. A theme is always longer than a summary. / Yes. Both should include the writer's opinion.]	**No. A summary tells the most important events; a theme tells the message about life those events show.**	A summary retells the most important events. A theme is the message about life those events show. You need the events to figure out the theme, but they are not the same thing.
d1_s2	Set 3: Which is the BEST summary of "What the River Knows"? [A hammer breaks limestone with one hard blow, but a river gently shapes stone over a thousand years into a home for living things. The speaker says patient kindness changes hearts and minds the same way. / It hums along its bed. Grain by grain. Turtles rest and lilies grow. / The poem is about a man who builds a stone house by a river with his hammer. / I liked how the poem rhymes, and stanza 3 was my favorite part.]	**A hammer breaks limestone with one hard blow, but a river gently shapes stone over a thousand years into a home for living things. The speaker says patient kindness changes hearts and minds the same way.**	The best summary covers every stanza in new words: the hammer's hard blow, the river's slow work over many years, and the speaker's lesson at the end. The others copy fragments, change the poem, or give an opinion.
d2_s2	Set 3: A summary keeps events in order. Which list puts the story's key events in the correct order? [Tessa chases Juniper → Uncle Femi gives advice → Tessa sits in the grass → Juniper accepts the halter / Uncle Femi gives advice → Tessa chases Juniper → Juniper accepts the halter → Tessa sits in the grass / Tessa sits in the grass → Tessa chases Juniper → Uncle Femi gives advice → Juniper accepts the halter / Juniper accepts the halter → Tessa sits in the grass → Tessa chases Juniper → Uncle Femi gives advice]	**Tessa chases Juniper → Uncle Femi gives advice → Tessa sits in the grass → Juniper accepts the halter**	In the story, Tessa chases first (paragraph 2), then Uncle Femi gives advice (paragraph 4), then she sits in the grass (paragraph 5), and finally Juniper accepts the halter (paragraph 6).

FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs1_s0	Set 1: Title punctuation: put quotation marks around the poem's title. In the poem What the River Knows, the river is patient.	**In the poem "What the River Knows," the river is patient.**	The title of a poem goes inside quotation marks, and the comma after the title goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s0	Set 1: Dialogue punctuation: add the missing comma. "She's impossible" Tessa said.	**"She's impossible," Tessa said.**	When the speaker tag comes after the words someone says, a comma goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs3_s0	Set 1: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. Finally Juniper walked to the barn beside Tessa.	**Finally, Juniper walked to the barn beside Tessa.**	Put a comma after an introductory word like "Finally."

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs4_s0	Set 1: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. The filly and her mother grazes by the fence.	**The filly and her mother graze by the fence.**	“The filly and her mother” is a compound subject (two animals), so it needs the plural verb “graze,” not “grazes.”
fs1_s1	Set 2: Commas in a series: add the commas between the three actions. The river shapes stone shelters turtles and feeds lilies.	**The river shapes stone, shelters turtles, and feeds lilies.** (also accepted: The river shapes stone, shelters turtles and feeds lilies.)	Use commas to separate the three actions in a series: shapes stone, shelters turtles, and feeds lilies.
fs2_s1	Set 2: Dialogue capitalization: fix the capital-letter mistake. Uncle Femi said, "try being something else."	**Uncle Femi said, "Try being something else."**	The first word of a quoted sentence is capitalized, even in the middle of your sentence.
fs3_s1	Set 2: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. However the filly ran to the far fence.	**However, the filly ran to the far fence.**	Put a comma after an introductory word like “However.”
fs4_s1	Set 2: Grammar: fix the its / it’s mistake. The river smooths the stone in it's path.	**The river smooths the stone in its path.**	“It’s” means “it is.” The path belongs to the river, so use the possessive “its” with no apostrophe.
fs1_s2	Set 3: Title capitalization: fix the three capital-letter mistakes in the title. My favorite fable is "the wind and the sun."	**My favorite fable is "The Wind and the Sun."**	Capitalize the first word and the important words of a title (The, Wind, Sun), but not short words like “and” or “the” in the middle. The period goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s2	Set 3: Dialogue punctuation: move the question mark to the right spot. "Why won't she come"? asked Tessa.	**"Why won't she come?" asked Tessa.**	The question mark belongs to the words Tessa asked, so it goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs3_s2	Set 3: Comma after an introductory phrase: add the missing comma. After almost an hour Tessa felt warm breath on her neck.	**After almost an hour, Tessa felt warm breath on her neck.**	Put a comma after an introductory phrase like “After almost an hour.”
fs4_s2	Set 3: Grammar: fix the their / there / they’re mistake. The turtles and herons share there shady pool.	**The turtles and herons share their shady pool.**	The pool belongs to the turtles and herons, so use the possessive “their,” not “there.”

BACK IT UP WITH EVIDENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s0	Set 1: This sentence shows that force fails. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 2): The faster Tessa chased, the farther Juniper ran. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "The faster Tessa chased, the farther Juniper ran."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word (including the comma after “chased”) inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s1	Set 2: This sentence shows that patience worked. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 6): That afternoon, Juniper walked to the barn beside Tessa, the rope hanging loose between them. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "That afternoon, Juniper walked to the barn beside Tessa, the rope hanging loose between them."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word, including both commas, inside quotation marks. The period goes inside the closing quotation mark.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s2	Set 3: This sentence shows patience slowly working. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 5): Out of the corner of her eye, she watched Juniper take one step closer, then two, then stop to graze. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "Out of the corner of her eye, she watched Juniper take one step closer, then two, then stop to graze."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and all three commas inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

WRITER'S TURN: WRITE A SUMMARY (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s0	Set 1: Summarize paragraphs 1 and 2 of the story in one or two sentences, in your own words. Text A, paragraphs 1–2: On a horse farm outside Ocala, Florida, a gray filly named Juniper had spent three days refusing to be caught. Every morning, Tessa Adebayo marched into the pasture... determined to lead the young horse to the barn for her first checkup. On the fourth morning, Tessa tried running... The faster Tessa chased, the farther Juniper ran. Use at least 15 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Names like Tessa, Juniper, and Ocala are fine to keep.) Name the main character: include Tessa. Name the horse: include Juniper (or the filly or horse). Keep the key event: say that Tessa chased or ran after her. Keep the result: say that the filly ran away or would not be caught. Original: "On a horse farm outside Ocala, Florida, a gray filly named Juniper had spent three days refusing to be caught. Every morning, Tessa Adebayo marched into the pasture with a halter in one hand and a rope in the other, determined to lead the young horse to the barn for her first checkup. On the fourth morning, Tessa tried running. She sprinted across the wet grass, waving the rope and calling, Juniper! Come here right now! The filly flicked her ears, spun on her back hooves, and galloped to the far fence. The faster Tessa chased, the farther Juniper ran."	**Sample:** Tessa wants to bring a young gray horse named Juniper in for a checkup, but when she chases the filly, Juniper only gallops farther away.	A strong summary names Tessa and Juniper, tells what Tessa wants, and tells what happens when she uses force (the chase makes the filly run farther), all in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 15 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: tessa; juniper or filly or horse or pony; chas or ran or run or sprint or rac; away or far or escap or fled or flee or gallop or refus or wouldn or would not or won't or not be caught.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s1	Set 2: Summarize paragraphs 5 and 6 of the story in one or two sentences, in your own words. Text A, paragraphs 5–6: So Tessa tried something else. She walked to the middle of the pasture, sat down in the tall grass, and turned her back to the filly... After almost an hour, Tessa felt warm breath on her neck... Tessa raised the halter, and the filly let it slide over her ears. That afternoon, Juniper walked to the barn beside Tessa, the rope hanging loose between them. Use at least 15 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Single words like halter and barn are fine to keep.) Name the main character: include Tessa. Keep the turning point: say that she sat quietly or waited patiently. Name the horse: include Juniper (or the filly or horse). Keep the ending: say that the filly came to her, took the halter, or walked to the barn. Original: “So Tessa tried something else. She walked to the middle of the pasture, sat down in the tall grass, and turned her back to the filly. She picked a few clover blossoms and hummed. Ten minutes passed. Twenty. Her legs began to tingle. Out of the corner of her eye, she watched Juniper take one step closer, then two, then stop to graze. After almost an hour, Tessa felt warm breath on her neck. Juniper lowered her soft gray nose and sniffed the clover in Tessa's hand. Slowly, without standing up, Tessa raised the halter, and the filly let it slide over her ears. That afternoon, Juniper walked to the barn beside Tessa, the rope hanging loose between them.”	**Sample:** Tessa sits quietly with her back to Juniper and waits for nearly an hour until the filly comes close, accepts the halter, and follows her to the barn.	A strong summary names Tessa and Juniper, keeps the turning point (sitting quietly and waiting), and keeps the ending (the filly comes to her and walks to the barn), all in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 15 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original; must include: tessa; sat or sit or quiet or still or wait or patient or calm; juniper or filly or horse or pony; halter or came or come or closer or approach or nudg or sniff or trust or barn or walk or follow.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s2	Set 3: Summarize the whole poem in one or two sentences, in your own words. Cover every stanza. Text B, “What the River Knows”: Look back at the poem on the Text B slide, or use the key lines here: “The hammer strikes the limestone hard” … “The river never strikes at all” … “A thousand years of quiet flow / have carved a bowl of stone” … “remember how the river’s art / is patient, slow, and kind.” Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the poem. Include stanza 1: mention the hammer. Include stanzas 2 and 3: mention the river. Say HOW the river works: slowly, gently, patiently, or over many years. Include stanza 4: say what the speaker teaches about changing hearts, minds, or people. Original: “The hammer strikes the limestone hard with one tremendous crack. It leaves a jagged, broken shard, then cannot put it back. The river never strikes at all. It hums along its bed, and grain by grain, and fall by fall, it smooths the stone instead. A thousand years of quiet flow have carved a bowl of stone where turtles rest and lilies grow, the river's work alone. So when you want to move a heart or change a stubborn mind, remember how the river's art is patient, slow, and kind.”	**Sample:** A hammer breaks limestone with one hard hit, but a river gently wears stone down over many years, which shows that patience and kindness can change people too.	A strong summary of a poem gives the main idea of each stanza in new words: the hammer’s hard hit, the river’s slow and gentle work, and the speaker’s lesson about changing hearts and minds. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original; must include: hammer; river or water or stream; slow or patien or gentl or years or time or smooth or quiet; heart or mind or kind or people or person or others.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match theme	**a message about life, in a full sentence**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match topic	**what a text is about, in a word or two**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match moral	**a lesson stated at the end of a fable**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match summary	**the most important events in your own words**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match genre	**a kind of writing, like a poem or a fable**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match stanza	**a group of lines in a poem**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match speaker	**the voice talking in a poem**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match narrator	**the voice telling a story**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match fable	**a short tale that ends with a moral**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match evidence	**words from the text that prove your idea**	2 points if matched on the first try.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match determined	**firmly decided, not giving up**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match tremendous	**very large or powerful**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match jagged	**having sharp, uneven edges**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match tingle	**a prickly, pins-and-needles feeling**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match patient	**able to wait calmly without giving up**	2 points if matched on the first try.

BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, find the theme all three texts share. Step 2, choose evidence for it from the POEM. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Theme: Patience and gentleness can accomplish more than force. Evidence: "remember how the river's art / is patient, slow, and kind." / Theme: Patience and gentleness can accomplish more than force. Evidence: "She picked a few clover blossoms and hummed." / Theme: Hard work always wins. Evidence: "remember how the river's art / is patient, slow, and kind." / Theme: Rivers are stronger than hammers. Evidence: "The river never strikes at all."]	**Theme: Patience and gentleness can accomplish more than force. Evidence: "remember how the river's art / is patient, slow, and kind."**	The shared theme is that patience and gentleness accomplish more than force, and "remember how the river's art / is patient, slow, and kind" is evidence from the POEM. The clover line comes from the story, not the poem; "Hard work always wins" is not the theme; and "Rivers are stronger than hammers" is a statement about the topic, not a message about life.
b2_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Rafael summarized the story: Tessa chased Juniper. I think chasing horses is mean. Uncle Femi had coffee. Then Juniper came to her. Which list names ALL of his problems? [It includes an opinion, it includes a tiny detail (the coffee), and it leaves out the turning point (Tessa sitting quietly). / It includes an opinion and nothing else is wrong. / It includes a tiny detail (the coffee) and nothing else is wrong. / It is too short; a summary should retell every sentence.]	**It includes an opinion, it includes a tiny detail (the coffee), and it leaves out the turning point (Tessa sitting quietly).**	Rafael's summary has three problems: an opinion ("I think chasing horses is mean"), a tiny detail (the coffee), and a missing key event (Tessa sitting quietly, the turning point that explains why Juniper came).
b1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation of how EACH genre shows the theme is correct for all three texts? [The fable states it as a moral; the story shows it through Tessa's change; the poem shows it through images, then states it in the last stanza. / The fable shows it through stanzas; the story states it as a moral; the poem has no theme. / All three state the theme in the title. / The story states it in the first line; the fable and the poem never show it.]	**The fable states it as a moral; the story shows it through Tessa's change; the poem shows it through images, then states it in the last stanza.**	The fable states the theme as a moral in its last line, the story shows it through Tessa's change, and the poem builds it with hammer-and-river images before stating it in stanza 4. The other answers mix up which genre does what.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b2_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Grace says the theme of the story is “Never chase a horse.” Step 1, is that a theme? Step 2, how should it be fixed? [It is advice about one situation, not a theme. Better: “People who are patient and gentle often achieve what force cannot.” / It is a strong theme. No fix is needed. / It is not a theme. Better: “Horses.” / It is not a theme. Better: “Tessa sits in the grass for almost an hour.”]	**It is advice about one situation, not a theme. Better: “People who are patient and gentle often achieve what force cannot.”**	“Never chase a horse” is advice about one situation, so it is not a theme. A theme is a statement about life that fits beyond the story, such as “People who are patient and gentle often achieve what force cannot.”
b1_s2	Set 3: Which NEW story would share the SAME theme as the fable, the story, and the poem? [A boy wants a shy kitten to trust him. Grabbing it fails, so he sits still near it every day until it climbs into his lap. / A girl practices piano every day for a year and wins a contest. / Two friends argue about a game and then go swimming. / A storm knocks down a barn, and the neighbors rebuild it together.]	**A boy wants a shy kitten to trust him. Grabbing it fails, so he sits still near it every day until it climbs into his lap.**	The kitten story has the same pattern: force (grabbing) fails, and patient gentleness (sitting still each day) succeeds. Practicing piano shows hard work, the swimming story has no clear lesson, and rebuilding the barn shows teamwork.
b2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Jaden wrote: “In the poem, the river wins because it hits the stone harder than the hammer does.” Which explanation is correct? [He has it backward. The poem says the river “never strikes at all”; it wins through slow, gentle patience. / He is right. The river is the stronger hitter. / He is wrong only because the poem has no hammer. / He is wrong because the hammer wins in the poem.]	**He has it backward. The poem says the river “never strikes at all”; it wins through slow, gentle patience.**	Stanza 2 says “The river never strikes at all.” The river wins through slow, gentle patience over a thousand years, not by hitting harder, so Jaden’s comparison gets the poem backward.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W19.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: claim and evidence	Claim: Our town should plant more trees. Evidence: A study found that shady streets stay 10 degrees cooler in summer.
2	Review: add the missing comma	However, trees cost money to plant.
3	Which one is a TOPIC?	Friendship
4	A lesson from a book, fable or movie	Answers vary. Check that the lesson is written as a full sentence.
5	Retell in two sentences	Answers vary. Look for only the most important events, in order.

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Summary and theme of the Grasshopper and the Ant	Model: All summer the Grasshopper sang while the Ant stored food. When winter came, the hungry Grasshopper had to beg the Ant for something to eat. Theme: It is wise to work and plan ahead for hard times.
2	Be the editor	a) In the story "Juniper in the Tall Grass," Tessa waits quietly. b) "Sit down slowly," Uncle Femi whispered. c) The horses in the pasture eat clover.
3	Best theme for “What the River Knows”	Patient, gentle effort can change what force cannot.
4	Writing: compare how two texts show the theme	Grading note: names the shared theme; a detail from each text; one sentence beginning “However,”; one correctly punctuated quotation.

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Short fable with the same theme	Grading note: animal characters, force failing and patience succeeding, and a moral stated at the end.